

Threads and Weaves of Rural Gujarat

15 January – 30 January 2027

Captivating India: Threads and Weaves of Rural Gujarat.

Gujarat with its vibrant colours, rich textile traditions, intricate artistic craftsmanship and strong community bonds, it is a captivating region to explore. Join us on this journey where we visit some of the best craftsmen and women who create magic in their rural villages.

This 16-day tour covering the best of Gujarat, offers a unique opportunity to explore centuries-old skills that continue to thrive in the modern world.

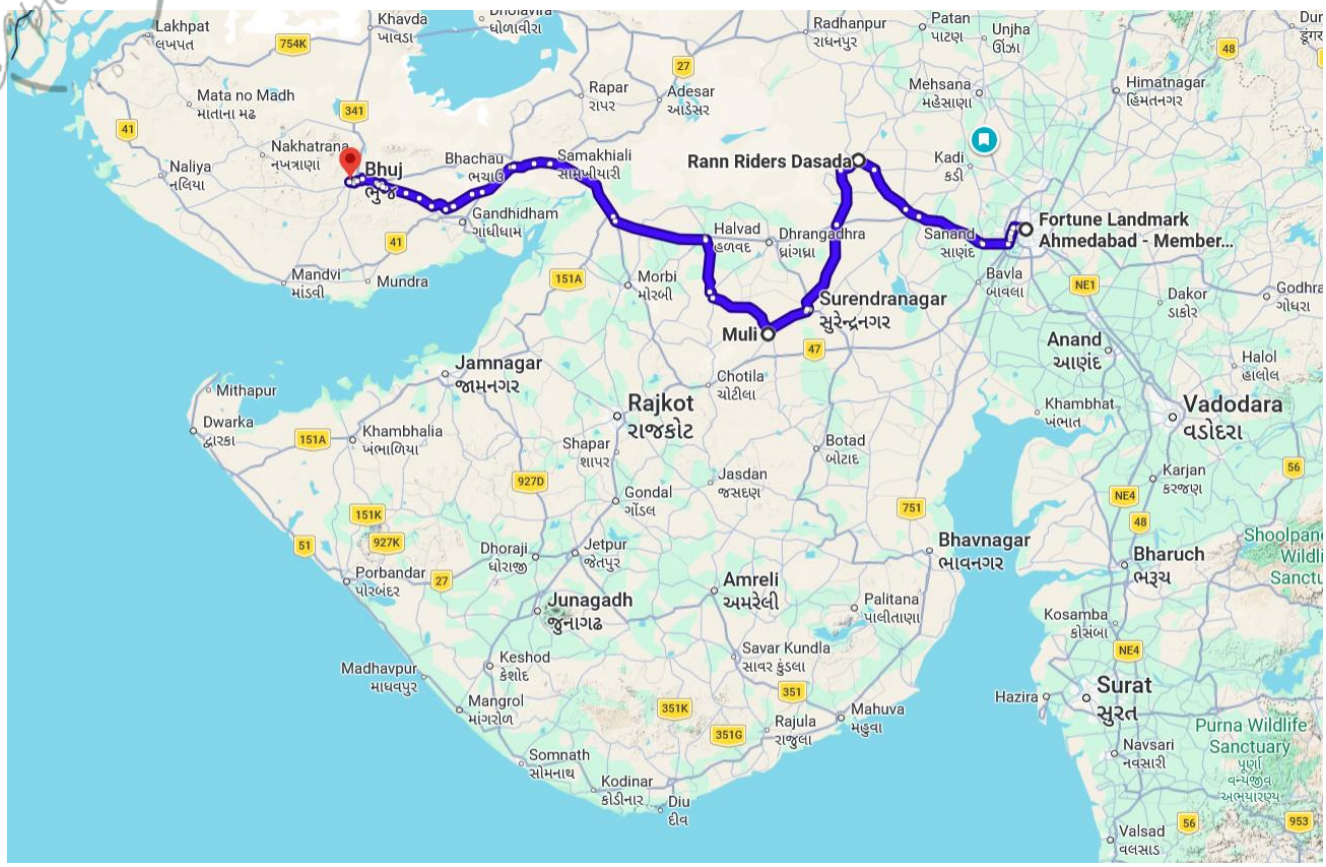
We travel through historic cities and remote craft villages, where artisans practice age-old methods such as Bandhani tie-dye, Patola double Ikat weaving, Ajrakh block printing and intricate Kutchi embroidery. Each textile reflects the identity, culture and traditions of the communities that create them.

On the tour we will be able to engage with artisans, understand the cultural significance of designs, and witness the sustainable practices that define these crafts. From the looms of Patan to the desert villages of Kutch, the tour is a celebration of colour, creativity and living heritage. You will also visit a couple of units of the Self-Employed Womens Association (SEWA), a sustainable empowerment project. Various workshops are arranged so you will also be able to have a hands-on experience and discover more about these intricate, artistic textile traditions.

In addition to workshops with hands-on experience, you will also get a true flavour of traditional life in India, visiting local homes and meeting the craftspeople of the village.



Map



Routing : Ahmedabad –Dasada – Muli – Bhuj – Mumbai

Detailed itinerary

Day 1 15 January 2027 Friday UK - Ahmedabad

Fly from the UK to Ahmedabad. We suggest flying to Mumbai and then connecting to a domestic flight to Ahmedabad. There is also a direct flight from Gatwick to Ahmedabad that currently operates thrice a week. Please note flights are not included but we will be happy to suggest the flights best suited for joining the tour.

Day 2 16 January 2027 Saturday Ahmedabad

Arrive Ahmedabad at midday. You will be met and transferred to your hotel in the city. Stay at the ITC Fortune Landmark or similar for 3 nights. This is a centrally located modern hotel with a choice of dining and modern facilities.

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Founded in 1411 on the banks of the Sabarmati River, Ahmedabad is known as the "Manchester of India" for its rich textile heritage and the ideal place to start our textile exploration of this vibrant state. We start with a guided tour of the Calico Museum, its collection of historical Indian textiles is considered by many to be the finest and most comprehensive in the world.

Day 3 17 January 2027 Sunday Ahmedabad

Enjoy a heritage walk in the morning. The old walled city of Ahmedabad is a UNESCO World Heritage Site and the heritage walk is a great way to explore, understand and experience this ancient city and its culture. Old wooden houses, local *haveli* house architecture, neighbourhood planning, bustling markets and different religious places are some of the highlights of the walk. You will have leisure time to visit some of the local textile shops if you would like to pick a bargain. A traditional evening meal will be arranged at a nearby restaurant.

Day 4 18 January 2027 Monday Ahmedabad

Visit the SEWA (Self-employed Women Association) unit in Ahmedabad. This women's empowerment organisation works towards uplifting the life of women especially in rural areas. Here you will be able to see the various activities that they do including making products from recycled material, and a handmade paper unit. A full-day workshop will be arranged where you will learn about textile patterns and designs, embroidery and making products out of recycled paper.

Day 5 19 January 2027 Tuesday Ahmedabad-Patan-Modhera-Dasada

Morning drive to Dasada visiting the towns of Patan and Modhera en-route. Patan is famous for the Patola weaving, The art is preserved by a few families and here you will get to see first hand how this exquisite fabric is made using double ikat technique, bold colours, and timeless patterning. This labour intensive art requires precise, mathematical accuracy in tie-dyeing both warp and weft threads, with sarees often taking 6–10 months to create. You also visit the Rani-ki-Vav, a monumental stepwell built in the 11th century. Recognized as a UNESCO World Heritage Site, the stepwell is not only a marvel of craftsmanship but also a testament to India's ancient water-management systems.

You drive on to visit the intricately carved sun temple at Modhera, built during 1026-27CE. With its intricately carved pillars and temple tank it is a fascinating monument to visit.

Later drive to Dasada in the Little Rann of Kutch. Stay at the Rann Riders Resort for 3 nights. This is an eco-lodge set on the edge of the Little Rann of Kutch, offering a blend of rustic charm and modern comfort. Designed with traditional architecture in mind, the resort features cottage-style accommodations inspired by local village homes.

Day 6 20 January 2027 Wednesday Dasada

Day to explore the nearby village where you will get to experience life in rural Gujarat and also explore the various communities who practice their very distinct styles of weaving and embroidery.

Day 7 21 January 2027 Thursday Dasada

Enjoy a safari in the Indian Wild Ass Sanctuary in Little Rann of Kutch. The sanctuary is known for its population of Wild Ass, the only place where these are seen. This unique saline desert ecosystem features arid flats and elevated islands full diverse wildlife including desert foxes, blue-bulls, and migratory birds like the flamingos. Remainder of the day will be at leisure to explore this lovely eco resort.

Day 8 22 January 2027 Friday Dasada – Muli

After a leisurely breakfast drive to Muli. Stay at the Ambika Nivas Palace for 2 nights. This ancestral palace of the royal family of Muli is now open to guests who would like the experience of staying in a heritage property. Explore the local village in the afternoon.

Day 9 23 January 2027 Saturday Muli

The day will be spent exploring the textile crafts of the region. You will get to see Tangalia Weaving, a 700-year-old weaving craft practiced by the Dangashiya community. And also the famous Single Ikat and Double Ikat Patola and Khadi, the hand-woven fabric made in village homes. We will learn more about cotton, from the farms to the Ginning process, cotton fibre and cotton weaving.

Day 10 24 January 2027 Sunday Muli – Bhuj

After a long drive we reach the historic city of Bhuj. Bhuj is the gateway to the Kutch region, known for its vast salt pans, deserts and vibrant textile and crafts. Bhuj will be our base to explore the White Rann, its villages and crafts over the next few days. Stay at the Regenta Resort for 5 nights. This is a comfortable property that offers accommodation in modern rooms and traditional Kutch-style cottages together with an outside swimming pool.

Day 11 25 January 2027 Monday Bhuj

We start with a visit to LLDC, The Living and Learning Design Centre in Ajrakhpur, one of India's finest craft museums, created by the Shrujan Trust to preserve and celebrate the region's extraordinary textile and embroidery traditions. We will spend the day at the centre with a visit to the Living Embroideries of Kutch museum that celebrates the rich, diverse and awe-inspiring embroideries of 12 different Kutchi communities. The exhibits include traditionally embroidered textiles as well as specially commissioned pieces and contemporary expressions – all displaying the highest levels of creative and technical excellence. We will also have workshops organised for you to learn more.

We will then visit the nearby village of Ajarakpur, one of the most important centres for natural-dye block printing in India, known for its deep indigo blues, madder reds, and intricate geometric patterns.

Day 12 26 January 2027 Tuesday Bhuj

The day will be spend at Nirona village learning more about the local arts and crafts, like copper bell making, lacquer work and Rogan art. We will have a hands-on workshop with the family that maintains Rogan art in the village. It involves creating raised, 3D floral, geometric, and "Tree of Life" motifs by painting with thick castor-oil-based pigments applied with a stylus.

Day 13 27 January 2027 Wednesday Bhuj

Visit a village in Hodka to see how this close-knit community live. This is a great opportunity to see real life in a rural Kutch village. We will also have a workshop to learn about Ahir, Meghwal, and Rabari embroidery that incorporates exquisite needle and mirror work. We will visit the White Rann to see the spectacular white desert and salt pans.

Day14 28 January 2027 Thursday Bhuj

Explore the historic city of Bhuj including a visit to the Aina Mahal, Prah Mahal and the historic mansions in town. Afternoon will be at leisure for shopping or a further exploration of the town.

Day 15 29 January 2027 Friday Bhuj- Mumbai

Transfer to the airport for a flight to Mumbai. Stay the night at the Iconica Hotel, a modern airport hotel that is convenient for departures.

Day 16 30 January 2027 Saturday Mumbai – UK

Transfer to the airport for your return flight to the UK.



Tour information

Tour price : will depend on the size of the group.

: £ 3170 per person (if group strength is 10-12 persons)

: £ 3820 per person (if group strength is 6-9 persons)

The tour is based on 2 people sharing a room. It is not mandatory to pay a single room supplement if you are happy to share a room with another person of the same sex. A single room supplement is required to be paid only if we do not have another person to share the room with you or you wish to stay in room on single occupancy.

Single room supplement (should you require it) : £ 860

Dates :

Departure date from the UK : 15 January 2027 Return back to the UK : 30 January 2027

Duration of the tour : 16 days

Group size :

Minimum group size : 6 persons Maximum group size : 12 persons

Meal Plan : Bed and breakfast.

(while on sightseeing excursions, light refreshments and meals in local restaurants as mentioned in the itinerary are also included)

Internal Travel :

Comfortable mini-bus that will remain at disposal for the entire tour. For some of the local tours smaller vehicles and tuk-tuks will be used to enhance the experience and ease of access to some of the sights.

Tour will be fully escorted and guaranteed to operate for a minimum of 6 persons. You will have a UK tour leader who will accompany the group for the full tour and experienced local guides/specialists.

What is included in the holiday price

- ✓ Accommodation in the hotels mentioned on twin-share inclusive of breakfast at the hotels.
- ✓ Transport from time of arrival at the airport in Ahmedabad until departure from Mumbai will be in a private chauffeur driven air-conditioned mini coach (where necessary local travel using tuk-tuks are also included.)

- ✓ Visits to places that are off the beaten track, off the main tourist circuit and local experiences with interactions with local communities and villagers
- ✓ UK tour leader to accompany the whole tour
- ✓ English speaking local guide to accompany the tour and specialist guides where necessary to enhance your local experiences and visits off the beaten track
- ✓ All scheduled sightseeing expenses including entrance fees at monuments
- ✓ We provide environmentally friendly metal refillable bottles and portable water along with light refreshments for all journeys
- ✓ Textile workshops with local artisans and at centres, as mentioned in the itinerary
- ✓ Welcome kit on arrival with eco-friendly cotton tote bags for travel, leather passport wallets, hand sanitisers, insect repellent spray/cream and baggage tags.
- ✓ 24x7 assistance from our dedicated team in-country for any queries or for emergency contact.

Excluded

- ❖ International flights (Please note flights are not included but we will be happy to suggest the flights best suited for joining the tour)
- ❖ India visa fees (Assistance can be provided for the online application process as it can sometimes be difficult but not the visa fee)
- ❖ Travel insurance (we would request you have a comprehensive insurance that would cover your holiday)
- ❖ Personal expenses like laundry, drinks, tips etc
- ❖ Meals other than those mentioned in the itinerary.

For more information on the tour do contact us on info@captivatingindia.co.uk or WhatsApp +44 7778403510 for a call back. We look forward to hearing from you and having you travel with us.

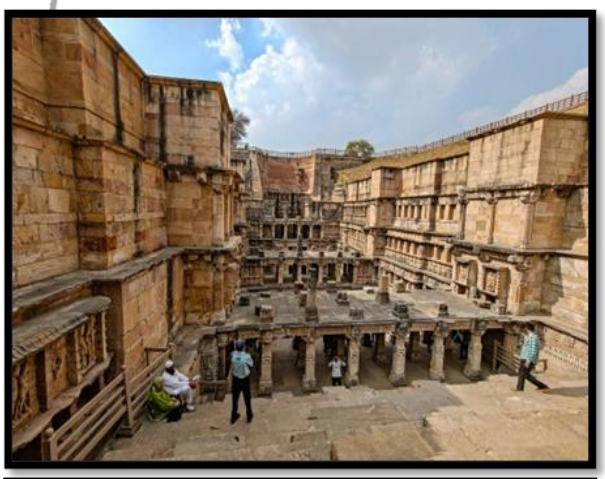
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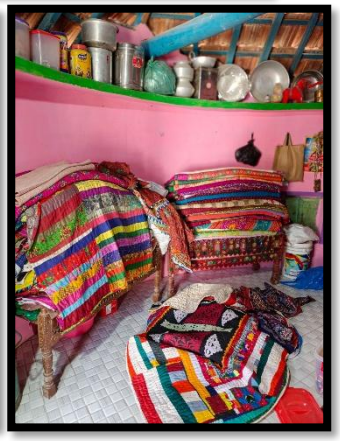









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